

HR Excellence in Research

GAP Analysis (Charter and Code Checklist)

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Case number

2024RO236122

Name Organisation under review

Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu

Organisation's contact details

10 Victoriei Blvd., Sibiu, Sibiu, 550024, Romania

Date endorsement charter and code

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GAP Analysis overview

The Charter and Code provides the basis for the Gap analysis. In order to aid cohesion, the GAP Analysis principles have been renumbered under the following headings. Please provide the outcome of your organisation's GAP analysis below. If your organisation currently does not fully meet the criteria, please list whether national or organisational legislation may be limiting the Charter's implementation, initiatives that have already been taken to improve the situation or new proposals that could remedy the current situation. In order to help the organisation's recruitment strategy, a specific self-assessment checklist is provided for Open, Transparent and Merit-Based Recruitment.

European Charter for Researchers and Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers : GAP analysis overview

- **Status** : to what extent does this organisation meet the following principles?
- **Implementation (++, +/-, -/+, --)** :
 - ++ fully implemented

- +/- almost but not fully implemented
- -/+ partially implemented
- -- insufficiently implemented
- **GAP** : In case of --, -/+, or +/-, please **indicate the actual “gap”** between the principle and the current practice in your organisation.
- **Implementation impediments** : If relevant, please list any national/regional legislation or organisational regulation currently impeding implementation.
- **Initiatives undertaken/new proposals** : If relevant, please list any initiatives that have already been taken to improve the situation and/or new proposals that could remedy the current situation.

Status

Ethical and Professional Aspects

Status

1. Research freedom

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
-/+ partially implemented	Lack of mechanisms for reporting possible violations.	Current practice: Freedom of research is foreseen in the ULBS Charter in the following form: Chapter IV – University Autonomy Art. 28 (1) Academic freedom is guaranteed by law. This implies the right of all members of the university community to express themselves freely, both within and outside the university environment, in relation to teaching, research, or intellectual creation, as well as any other activities relating to the higher education institution in which they work, in accordance with the law. To the same extent, academic freedom means the freedom to learn, teach, and research, each of which implies the freedom to think, question, and share ideas, both within and outside the higher education institution. (2) Academic freedom is manifested through: a) the right of members of the university community to freely produce, acquire, develop, and transmit knowledge through research, debate, teaching, reading, and publishing, with the results being recognized at ULBS, under the conditions of the law and in accordance with internal regulations; b) the right to research topics of professional and scientific interest, in compliance with ethical standards and specific codes of conduct; c) the right of members of the academic community to freely express their opinions on professional and scientific topics; d) the right to openly express their scientific and professional opinions in courses, seminars, conferences, debates, as well as in papers written, presented, or published; e) the right to identify and choose problem-solving methods in accordance with recognized ethical principles and practices (3) Academic freedom also implies respect for the academic freedom of others in all its aspects. (4) The university is organized and operates independently of any ideological, political, or religious interference. Principles and rules of academic ethics and conduct Art 3. (1) In accordance with legal regulations and the ULBS Charter, academic freedom is guaranteed at ULBS. ULBS is a space free from political, religious, economic, or other forms of interference, pressure, or coercion, where education, learning, knowledge, scientific research, morality, and ethics are promoted. (2) Members of the academic community are protected from any type of censorship, manipulation, or persecution, provided that scientific standards and professional responsibilities are respected. (3) Responsible use of academic freedom is encouraged to avoid the dissemination of false or manipulative information. (4) Academic freedom implies the right of any member of the university community to openly express their scientific and professional opinions in courses, seminars, conferences, debates, as well as in papers written, defended, or published, in compliance with the rules of academic ethics and professional conduct. (5) Freedom of research is a prerequisite for achieving the goal of research activity and is based on freedom of thought and expression, while also implying the researcher's right to identify and choose methods for solving problems in accordance with recognized ethical principles and practices. (6) Academic freedom also implies respect for the academic freedom of others in all its aspects. (7) The following are not considered academic freedom and constitute unacceptable conduct in the university environment: a) political propaganda carried out within or in connection with the University's activities or using its infrastructure; b) religious proselytism; c) the promotion of extremist, racist, or xenophobic doctrines or ideas; d) defamation of the University by members of the university community; e) personal attacks or defamatory statements against other members of the university community. Internal regulation: ULBS Charter 2025 https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta%20ULBS%202025_Proiect.pdf Suggestions for improvement: • Development of an internal procedure for protecting academic freedom. • Drafting of an institutional policy and an operational guide (including an anonymous reporting mechanism). • Reaching a consensus regarding the constraints on certain research topics—constraints which, at present, do not exist. Proposals: Action Plan, Measure Action 1

Status

2. Ethical principles

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented	Current practice: Freedom of research is foreseen in the ULBS Charter in the following form: Chapter IV – University Autonomy Art. 28 (1) Academic freedom is guaranteed by law. This implies the right of all members of the university community to express themselves freely, both within and outside the university environment, in relation to teaching, research, or intellectual creation, as well as any other activities relating to the higher education institution in which they work, in accordance with the law. To the same extent, academic freedom means the freedom to learn, teach, and research, each of which implies the freedom to think, question, and share ideas, both within and outside the higher education institution. (2) Academic freedom is manifested through: a) the right of members of the university community to freely produce, acquire, develop, and transmit knowledge through research, debate, teaching, reading, and publishing, with the results being recognized at ULBS, under the conditions of the law and in accordance with internal regulations; b) the right to research topics of professional and scientific interest, in compliance with ethical standards and specific codes of conduct; c) the right of members of the academic community to freely express their opinions on professional and scientific topics; d) the right to openly express their scientific and professional opinions in courses, seminars, conferences, debates, as well as in papers written, presented, or published; e) the right to identify and choose problem-solving methods in accordance with recognized ethical principles and practices (3) Academic freedom also implies respect for the academic freedom of others in all its aspects. (4) The university is organized and operates independently of any ideological, political, or religious interference. Principles and rules of academic ethics and conduct Art 3. (1) In accordance with legal regulations and the ULBS Charter, academic freedom is guaranteed at ULBS. ULBS is a space free from political, religious, economic, or other forms of interference, pressure, or coercion, where education, learning, knowledge, scientific research, morality, and ethics are promoted. (2) Members of the academic community are protected from any type of censorship, manipulation, or persecution, provided that scientific standards and professional responsibilities are respected. (3) Responsible use of academic freedom is encouraged to avoid the dissemination of false or manipulative information. (4) Academic freedom implies the right of any member of the university community to openly express their scientific and professional opinions in courses, seminars, conferences, debates, as well as in papers written, defended, or published, in compliance with the rules of academic ethics and professional conduct. (5) Freedom of research is a prerequisite for achieving the goal of research activity and is based on freedom of thought and expression, while also implying the researcher's right to identify and choose methods for solving problems in accordance with recognized ethical principles and practices. (6) Academic freedom also implies respect for the academic freedom of others in all its aspects. (7) The following are not considered academic freedom and constitute unacceptable conduct in the university environment: a) political propaganda carried out within or in connection with the University's activities or using its infrastructure; b) religious proselytism; c) the promotion of extremist, racist, or xenophobic doctrines or ideas; d) defamation of the University by members of the university community; e) personal attacks or defamatory statements against other members of the university community. Internal regulation: ULBS Charter 2025 https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta%20ULBS%202025_Proiect.pdf Suggestions for improvement: • Development of an internal procedure for protecting academic freedom. • Drafting of an institutional policy and an operational guide (including an anonymous reporting mechanism). • Reaching a consensus regarding the constraints on certain research topics—constraints which, at present, do not exist. Proposals: Action Plan, Measure Action 1 Current practice: There is an Ethics Committee and there are dedicated regulations. https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/despre/organizare/structura/consilii-si-comisii/comisia-de-etica/ There are certain principles and rules stipulated in the ULBS Charter. https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta%20ULBS%202025_Proiect.pdf Principles and rules of academic ethics and conduct Art. 2 The ULBS Code of Conduct and Academic Ethics promotes the following principles: a) the principle of academic freedom; b) the principle of public accountability; c) the principle of fairness; d) the principle of non-discrimination and equal opportunities; e) the principle of transparency; f) the principle of moral and professional integrity; g) the principle of the right to defense; h) the principle of independence from any moral, scientific, religious, political, economic, or other influence in teaching or scientific activity; i) the principle of respect for the rights and freedoms of members of the academic community; j) the principle of moral, social, and professional responsibility; k) the principle of guaranteeing the cultural identity of all members of the academic community and intercultural dialogue; l) the principle of impartiality and objectivity; m) the principle of promoting the best interests of the direct beneficiary. Internal regulations: The internal regulations setting out the ethical principles governing the conduct of research at ULBS are included in the university's Strategic Plan. https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/281124/2_Planul%20strategic_Senat_noiem2024.pdf

Status**3. Professional responsibility**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	Although clear principles and rules of professional responsibility are defined, there is no structured mechanism to monitor, evaluate, or reinforce their practical application. Awareness and adherence rely mainly on individual responsibility rather than ongoing training, guidance, or systematic oversight.	Current practice: Principles and rules of academic ethics and conduct (5) Academic professionalism is characterised in research activity by: a) competence, integrity, and self-regulation (peer review: the obligation to submit to critical examination prior to the defense or publication of a paper); b) compliance with established professional standards through documentation and interpretation of results; c) the researcher's obligation to ensure that their work is relevant to society and does not duplicate research previously carried out elsewhere; as an exception, the repetition of previous research is acceptable if it can lead to new results; d) publicly acknowledging the professional or material contribution of other persons or institutions to the results achieved; e) promoting cooperation within research teams; f) protecting the security of preliminary data; g) mutual information on relevant developments in the field and on research methodologies; h) promoting intellectual honesty and integrity; i) declaring and resolving, in accordance with the law, incompatibilities and conflicts of interest; j) respect for the informed consent of those involved in the research, as well as their safety; k) compliance with all legal and ethical requirements regarding research; l) acceptance of critical debate on the results obtained. https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta%20ULBS%202025_Proiect.pdf Internal regulation: Intellectual property protection procedure https://centers.ulbsibiu.ro/itchpiulbs/docs/pi/po-dppi-pr-drepturi-de-autor.pdf Suggestions for improvement: Improving research mentoring through COCERC (Center Career Guidance in Research, Central Region). For certain fields, mentoring is offered to ULBS doctoral students in the area of research. For postdoctoral students and young researchers, a procedure regarding mentoring in research activities is required. https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/281124/2_Planul%20strategic_Senat_noiem2024.pdf Proposals: Action Plan, Action 2

Status

4. Professional attitude

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	Although strategic frameworks and structures support research quality and collaboration, there is no specific mechanism to actively foster, assess, or enhance researchers' professional attitudes. Engagement with strategic goals largely depends on individual initiative, with limited structured programs for cultivating proactive, collaborative, and innovation-oriented mindsets.	Current practice: Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu bases its research activity on the Research, Development, and Innovation (RDI) Strategy 2025–2034 https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/misiune-si-strategie/, published in July 2025, a strategic document that sets the directions and objectives for innovation and research at the institutional level. The Research, Development, and Innovation (RDI) Department is in charge of making sure everything goes smoothly, with responsibilities including: • promoting research quality; • implementing the RDI strategy and operational plan; • coordinating projects, scientific events, and reports; • developing a culture of intellectual property and supporting technology transfer. In the field of innovation and collaboration with industry, a central role is played by the Hasso Plattner Knowledge Transfer Institute https://centers.ulbsibiu.ro/itchpiulbs/en/ (HPI-ULBS) https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/6_STATUTUL-INSTITUTULUI-DE-TRANSFER-DE-CUNOA%C8%98TERE-HPI-%E2%80%93ULBS-HPI-KNOWLEDGE-TRANSFER-INSTITUTE-AT-LBUS.pdf, a strategic hub for regional development of innovation, digital transformation, and applied research, with results in prototyping, intellectual property, and research exploitation. The Hasso Plattner Knowledge Transfer Institute (HPI-ULBS) was active in 2023 https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/280324/1_Raportul%20rektorului%20privind%20starea%20ULBS_Senat_martie2024.pdf in key areas such as attracting funds from economic partners and public institutions, supporting access to European funding, and collaborating in regional IT clusters (Sibiu IT https://sibiu-it.ro/membri/ and Cluj IT https://www.clujit.ro/our-members/#universities). HPI-ULBS https://centers.ulbsibiu.ro/itchpiulbs/en/ co-organises the annual Sibiu Innovation Days https://events.ulbsibiu.ro/innovationdays/, a major event that brings together academia, industry and local authorities in a platform for technology transfer and innovation, with the 2025 edition scheduled for 6-7 November. Professional responsibility is reinforced by the Internal Audit Charter, which defines internal auditing as an independent and objective activity aimed at evaluating the effectiveness of internal control, risk management, and ensuring good institutional governance. Furthermore, the Regulations of the Ethics Committee and the Research Ethics Subcommittee (adopted in November 2024) establish the procedural framework for assessing and monitoring compliance with ethical standards in academic and research activities, ensuring the independence and impartiality of these processes. Current National Plan for Research, Development and Innovation 2022-2027 https://www.mcid.gov.ro/wp-content/uploads/2022/12/hg-aprobare-pncdi-iv.pdf describes strategic goals and funding mechanisms in line with the European Commission's Strategy for research and innovation https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/strategy/strategy-2020-2024_en Internal regulations: • Lucian Blaga University Research, Development, and Innovation Strategy for 2025-2034: Link https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/Strategia-ULBS-2025-2034-2.pdf • ULBS Internal Audit Charter: Link https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta-Auditului-Intern.pdf • ULBS University Ethics Committee Regulations: Link https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/281124/13_Regulamentul%20Comisiei%20de%20Etica%20si%20a%20Subcomisiei%20de%20etica%20cercetarii_Senat_noiem2024.pdf • ULBS Strategy for 2025-2034: Link - https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/300125/2_Strategia%20ULBS_Senat_ian2025.pdf Suggestions for improvement: Regular training sessions for researchers, teaching staff, and administrative staff will focus on identifying funding opportunities and analyzing eligibility criteria, as well as selecting the most suitable calls, drafting project proposals, and justifying budgets. These sessions will include training on project management, technical and financial reporting, and the application of rules on eligible expenses, as well as issues related to intellectual property, protection of results, and planning for their dissemination. Risk assessment methods and strategies for ensuring the sustainability of projects after the end of the funding period will also be addressed. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 3

Status**5. Contractual and legal obligations**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	Carta requires compliance, but no process to inform researchers of obligations in any document (Art. 17)	Current practice Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu operates on the basis of the University Charter (Link) https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta%20ULBS%202025_Proiect.pdf, which establishes the legal framework and fundamental principles of operation. The activity of the staff is carried out in accordance with the Collective Labor Agreement at the ULBS level (Link) https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/CCM_03.12.2024_ULBS.pdf and the Regulations on the rights and obligations of teaching and research staff (included in the Charter) https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/260625/2_CARTA%20ULBS_Senat_iunie2025.pdf, which detail the professional responsibilities and applicable legal provisions. Compliance with national legislation in the field of labor, education, and research is ensured by integrating the relevant normative acts into internal procedures and through the work of the Legal Department. Individual employment contracts include clauses relating to rights, obligations, and intellectual property protection, and for research projects, agreements and grant contracts are concluded in accordance with specific legislation (UEFISCDI, Horizon Europe, etc.). Compliance monitoring is supported by the Internal Audit Charter https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta-Auditului-Intern.pdf, which provides for checks on the legality and regularity of administrative and financial procedures, including in the implementation of projects. Internal regulations: The scientific research regulations align ULBS research activities with the national legal framework on education, the status of teaching and research staff, and the provisions of the ULBS Charter. They are available on the Host Research https://hostcercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/doc_DCS/proceduri/Reg_cercetare_stiintifica.pdf platform and on the official website of the CDI Service (Link) https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/infrastructura-de-cercetare/proiecte-de-cercetare/proceduri-si-regulamente-proiecte-de-cercetare/. These regulations, together with the procedures related to research projects, establish the responsibilities, stages, and standards to be followed in the initiation, implementation, and completion of scientific projects, ensuring compliance with legal and institutional requirements. Regulations for doctoral studies, which define the procedures for the organization, admission, and supervision of doctoral students, including the administrative structure (IOSUD/CSUD): (Link) https://doctorate.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/RODSUD-Regulament-doctorate-varianta-2022.pdf Regulations for the recognition and establishment of research units, which structure research centers at the institutional level. (Link) https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/infrastructura-de-cercetare/centre-de-cercetare/proceduri-si-regulamente/ Suggestions for improvement: • Translation into English of relevant internal regulations Proposals: Action Plan, Action 4

Status

6. Accountability

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	Carta (Art. 8 & Art. 7), strategic plan (p. 28), and ethics regulations (Art. 2, (2)) ensure transparency.	Current practice At Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu, the responsibilities of teaching and research staff are set out in individual employment contracts (Link https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/CCM_ULBS_2022.pdf and job descriptions, in accordance with the provisions of the Labor Code (Law No. 53/2003, republished, as amended) and the Higher Education Law No. 199/2023. Research funded from public funds is carried out in accordance with Romanian and European legislation, and ULBS staff involved in such projects are required to submit regular technical and financial reports to the funders. The activities and results are reflected annually in the Rector's Report and in the reports of the ULBS Senate, which include data or the projects carried out, their status, and performance indicators. Internal audit mechanisms are regulated by the ULBS Internal Audit Charter (Link https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta-Auditului-Intern.pdf, which ensures the verification of the compliance of research project expenses and reports. Compliance with ethical standards and the prevention of conflicts of interest are monitored by the University Ethics Committee and the Research Ethics Subcommittee (Link https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/281124/13_Regulamentul%20Comisiei%20de%20Etica%20si%20a%20Subcomisiei%20de%20etica%20cercetarii_Senat_noiem2024.pdf). In accordance with internal procedures, all research activities are public and transparent: results funded by public funds are published in specialized journals, communicated at conferences, or posted on project websites, mentioning the project code and title. Project expenditures also comply with public procurement legislation and are published on dedicated official platforms (e.g., Link). https://e-licitatie.ro/pub Internal regulations: • Internal Audit Charter – defines internal audit and control procedures (Link). https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta-Auditului-Intern.pdf • Regulations of the Ethics Committee and the Research Ethics Subcommittee – regulates the ethical analysis of projects and the management of conflicts of interest (Link). https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/281124/13_Regulamentul%20Comisiei%20de%20Etica%20si%20a%20Subcomisiei%20de%20etica%20cercetarii_Senat_noiem2024.pdf • Regulations on scientific research activity and project procedures (Link). https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/infrastructura-de-cercetare/proiecte-de-cercetare/proceduri-si-regulamente-proiecte-de-cercetare/ • Labor Code (Law No. 53/2003, republished, with subsequent amendments) (Link). https://www.mmuncii.ro/j33/images/Documente/Legislatie/2018/2018-04-13_legea-53din2003-republicata-Codul_Muncii.pdf • Higher Education Law No. 199/2023 (Link). https://www.aracis.ro/wp-content/uploads/2024/10/legea-invatamantului-superior-nr-199-2023.pdf Suggestions for improvement: • Create a public online dashboard listing research projects (title, code, budget, funding source, status). • Organize annual training sessions for researchers and administrative staff on transparency, accountability, and ethical compliance in research. • Implementing periodic internal evaluations of project management processes and publishing their results. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 5

Status**7. Good practice in research**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented		Current practice: The Labour Code (Law 53/2003) https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliiDocumentAfis/41625 applies to all categories of employees in Romania, including academic and research staff, outlining their rights and obligations regarding occupational safety, working conditions, and responsibilities. At the institutional level, the ULBS Code of Conduct https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/111220/2_Regulament%20de%20ordine%20interioara_Senat_dec2020.pdf complements this legal framework by regulating workplace discipline and professional conduct, ensuring alignment with national labor legislation. In line with these principles, the ULBS Strategy 2025–2034 https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/Strategia-ULBS-2025-2034-2.pdf emphasizes strategic objectives concerning good research practices, sustainability, open science, digitalization, and the integration of artificial intelligence in research, reinforcing institutional commitment to responsible and innovative scientific activity. Regarding digital infrastructure, ULBS benefits from centralized IT services managed by the Direcția de Informatizare și Comunicații de Date https://ccom.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/ (DICD), which ensures the operation and security of institutional networks, digital platforms, email systems, and data communication services. The university is also integrated into national academic networks, such as RoEduNet, and has access to scientific resources through AnelisPlus, which support secure communication, data access, and institutional-level backup systems that are essential for research and academic continuity. The protection of personal and research data is ensured through the national implementation of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR – EU Regulation 2016/679) https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2016/679/oj/eng, complemented by Law 363/2018 https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliiDocument/209627 on personal data protection in Romania. ULBS has appointed an employee responsible for data protection in accordance with these regulations, as stated in the university's Privacy Policy. https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/politica-confidentialitate Within ULBS, ethical oversight of research is ensured by the Subcommittee for Research Ethics https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/despre/organizare/structura/consilii-si-comisii/subcomisia-de-etica-in-cercetarea-stiintifica-cecs/ (CECS), a specialized body functioning under the authority of the university's Committee of Ethics. This subcommittee is responsible for the ethical evaluation of proposed research projects. CECS issues ethical approvals for studies involving human participants and/or animal subjects, and promotes adherence to ethical standards in all scientific research activities conducted under ULBS. Its work is guided by Law 206/2004 https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliiDocument/52457 on good conduct in scientific research, the ULBS Code of Ethics and its Charter, where topics such as integrity, plagiarism, academic fraud and falsification are regulated. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 5

Status

8. Dissemination, exploitation of results

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	Carta (Art. 25) emphasizes citation and visibility, but no policy for broader dissemination.	Current practice: Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu actively promotes the dissemination and exploitation of research results through a clear regulatory framework and dedicated institutional tools. GRADIS – the Guide for the Evaluation of Teaching and Scientific Activities (Link) https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/gradis/ requires the publication of at least two scientific articles per year for teaching and research staff (exception: sports and arts), and for university professors, at least one of the articles must be published in the "excellence segment" (ISI journals with high impact factor or books/chapters published by prestigious publishers). The scientific results are exploited through contractual collaborations with third parties and through intellectual property protection, with ULBS submitting annual patent applications to the State Office for Inventions and Trademarks (OSIM) and the European Patent Office (EPO). The official website of the ULBS Research, Development, and Innovation Service (Link) https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/infrastructura-de-cercetare/proiecte-de-cercetare/ regularly publishes calls for projects, information about funding competitions, ongoing projects and results, as well as internal guidelines and procedures for project implementation. This regular update supports the academic community's transparent access to research opportunities and the dissemination of results. The dissemination activity is also supported by the 23 research centers of ULBS, which operate at the level of faculties and interdisciplinary platforms. These centers organize conferences, workshops, summer schools, and participate in international projects, facilitating the transfer of research results to the academic and socio-economic environment (Link). https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/infrastructura-de-cercetare/centre-de-cercetare/lista-centre-de-cercetare/ According to the Reports of the Rector and the Senate of ULBS (2024), the university has carried out over 20 research projects with national and international funding and has submitted eight international proposals, four of which to Horizon 2020 competitions (2024 Vice-Rector's Research Report https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/300125/4_Raport%20prorector%20cercetare%20privind%20actv%20desf%20in%20anul%202024_Senat_ian2025.pdf, 2024-2025 Rector's Report https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/270325/2_Raportul%20Rectorului%20privind%20starea%20universitatii_Senat_martie2025.pdf). The COCERC project (2023–2026) coordinated by ULBS includes extensive dissemination activities at local, regional, and national levels, including the formation of a network of counseling centers for researchers and students (project details). https://grants.ulbsibiu.ro/cocerc/en/ An important platform for knowledge transfer is Sibiu Innovation Days (2025 edition) https://events.ulbsibiu.ro/innovationdays/index.php#about-section, co-organized since 2020 by the Hasso Plattner Institute for Knowledge Transfer, which facilitates dialogue between academia, industry, and the public sector, supporting the applicability of research and regional innovation. ULBS also complies with ARACIS standards and performance indicators for research activities, including the obligation to ensure the visibility of results, participation in scientific networks, and the transfer of knowledge to the socio-economic environment. These requirements are integrated into internal dissemination strategies and procedures, in accordance with the ARACIS external evaluation methodology (Link). https://www.aracis.ro/wp-content/uploads/2024/08/HG-962_2024-Metodologia-ARACIS.pdf Internal regulations: • ULBS Research, Development, and Innovation Strategy for 2025-2034 (Link). https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/Strategia-ULBS-2025-2034-2.pdf • GRADIS – Guide for the evaluation of teaching and scientific activities – establishes performance indicators for research and publication requirements (Link). https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/gradis/ • Regulations on research activity – regulates the implementation of projects, dissemination of results, and protection of intellectual property (Link). https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/infrastructura-de-cercetare/proiecte-de-cercetare/proceduri-si-regulamente-proiecte-de-cercetare/ • Internal RDI procedures – instructions for project management, reporting, and dissemination (available on the RDI platform - (Link). https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/infrastructura-de-cercetare/proiecte-de-cercetare/ Suggestions for improvement: • Organizing regular thematic workshops to train researchers in dissemination, exploitation, and networking, including in programs such as Horizon Europe. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 6

Status

9. Public engagement

Status

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	ULBS Charter mentions community partnerships, but no specific public outreach mechanisms.	Current practice: With regard to the university's public commitment, references to this aspect can be found in the ULBS Strategic Plan for the period 2024-2029. (Link) https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/281124/2_Planul%20strategic_Senat_noiem2024.pdf Commitment to Students and Community ULBS continues to be an active partner in the development of the community in Sibiu and the Central Region, through collaboration with local authorities and the business community. The university has invested in modernizing its campuses and expanding its student support services. The SMARHub Center, for example, supports students' personal and professional development, facilitating their transition to the labor market and promoting a holistic education focused on developing socio-emotional and professional skills. European Researchers' Night Another event organised annually by Lucian Blaga University in Sibiu, which contributes to fulfilling the university's public commitment to the community, is Researchers' Night. ULBS organizes a local event dedicated to citizens European Researchers' Night. Every year, on the last Friday of September, ULBS invites children and adults of all ages to attend over 100 workshops and exhibitions of ULBS in which researchers elicit general public's interest in science in accessible formats. Schools and High Schools from Sibiu and surroundings are coming to this event that has a great popularity. In September 2025, the 12th edition takes place in Sibiu. Researchers' Night represents the convergence of the involvement of organizers, partners, funders, and the economic and social environment in order to ensure access to information on career guidance opportunities and the sustainability of education. The project is an example of good practice, highlighting the importance of public engagement and science education as vital elements in making science more attractive and motivating young people to pursue a career in research. The Cultural Heritage Lab Likewise, ULBS has launched in 2023 the Cultural Heritage Lab that invites practices of co-creation between scientists from Social Sciences and Humanities as well as external partners (NGOS, enterprises, artists) in the field of cultural heritage. This initiative is part of both FORTHEM and ELABCHROM projects. ULBS researchers also participate in dissemination through various non-academic channels such as podcasts, and online platforms ANTROPEDIA, https://antropedia.com/ ULBS held in October 2024 Sibiu Innovation Days https://events.ulbsibiu.ro/innovationdays/ that continues the series of SID (2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023) playing an important role in the development of collaborative networks between specialists from industry, public administration and the academic research community. The event is looking to strengthen the collaboration among all these stakeholders, while also improving the way in which we understand and use the innovative services available in Transylvania and in the Sibiu region. EPICS Project EPICS is a European KA2 project to empower universities, students, and local communities to co-create knowledge and foster civic engagement. 8 institutions will create pilots in 6 countries to design academic research actions with students and communities. (Link) https://www.epicsproject.eu/ The project is about citizen science, civic commitment, service learning, deliberative democracy. The objectives of the projects revolves around: • creating a training for students and researchers on citizen science, research service learning, co-design methodologies and participatory practices. • a digital platform with deliberative arenas for building and delivering citizen science and research service learning projects. • 6 pilot projects engaging local communities in citizen science initiatives. • a toolkit for replicating the model across Europe. • a handbook with guidelines, methodologies, and best practices for effectively engaging communities in design research actions. Unlock Design Thinking At ULBS D-School, the space is designed to support collaboration and participatory processes. Some of the professors who participated in the Design Thinking courses at ULBS D-School applied elements of DT with their students and invited the D-School team of volunteers to hold workshops at their faculty. Thus, DT is not used to completely change the teaching method or just to make classes more dynamic, but also to rethink the layout of classrooms (Faculty of Letters and Arts), redesigning the entrance area to the ULBS Library, developing ideas for extracurricular activities together with students (Faculty of Engineering and Faculty of Economic Sciences), etc. (Link) https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/news/initiativa-unlock-the-d-school-devine-unlock-design-thinking/ COCerc – Center for Research Career Guidance – Central Region The aim of the project is to increase interest in science among Romanian society, particularly among young people (school pupils and students), while also increasing the capacity of researchers (doctoral students, postdoctoral researchers, and senior researchers) to carry out high-quality research and communicate scientific results to policy makers and the general public. Among the specific objectives of COCerc are: • promoting the benefits of science in society and the scientific results of RDI organizations in the Central Region at local, regional, national, and international levels by organizing public events and disseminating audio-visual content (6 public debates, 6 science café events, 5 exhibitions, 15 science promotion actions in the media, 5 audio-video materials presenting science, 21 press articles in Romanian, 10 press articles in English, 6 interviews). • promoting research careers among students by organizing science promotion visits to schools and high schools (30 visits) and programs for students organized in laboratories, centers, or research infrastructures (10 events); • promoting research careers among undergraduate and master's students by facilitating internships in RDI organizations (2 facilitation actions) and career guidance services (500 undergraduate and master's students); Suggestions for improvement: More dissemination activities to be developed during the next three years

Status

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
		through COCERC project that aims at popularizing science among youth through specific information campaigns. (Link) https://grants.ulbsibiu.ro/cocerc/despre/ Proposals: Action Plan, Action 5 Action Plan, Action 6
10. Non discrimination		
Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented		Current practice: ULBS has adopted the decision 4344/28.09.2023 for the creation of Bureau for equity, diversity and inclusion subordinated to the Vice-rector responsible for the relationship with students and the community. Within FORTHEM Alliance there are a number of activities related to this topic and ULBS, as member of the Alliance, takes part in the FORTHEM communities of practice and knowledge sharing. ULBS has a number of special positions for Roma students /researchers and Moldovan citizens. Likewise, according to the Law 448/2006, organizations with more than 50 employees have to hire disabled people in a proportion of at least 4% of their total workforce. Failing to comply with this results in paying penalties that are calculated on a monthly basis by multiplying the national minimum wage (i.e. 3000 RON as of 2023) with the number of unoccupied positions dedicated to disabled persons. This measure of positive discrimination is meant to redress the disadvantaged situation with respect to employment rate that is only 15,9% for the disabled people in Romania in 2022 according to the National Institute of Statistics . The ULBS Code of conduct sets up rules regarding non-discrimination and attacks on the dignity in Chapter II. Moreover, in Chapter III of the above mentioned document there are rules regarding the equality of treatment between men and women. ULBS Carta also lists under art. 5, j) the equal chances of men and women and the social inclusion as one of the main principles governing the activity within the organization. Internal regulation: Rules of conduct and ethics relating to respect for human life and dignity - (Link) https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta%20ULBS%202025_Proiect.pdf The University Charter stipulates, under letter g), the prohibition of any form of exploitation, harassment of any kind, or discrimination on the grounds of political opinion, race, religion, sex, sexual orientation, national origin, marital status, disability and/or medical condition, age, citizenship, or other arbitrary or personal grounds. Gender Equality Plan in ULBS (2022-2027) - (Link) https://www.turnulsfatului.ro/uploads/media/2023/10/10/9-planul-privind-egalitatea-de-gen-senat-16-12-2021-6dfq.pdf ULBS action directions to promote gender equality The Plan for Gender Equality at Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu includes measures centered on the following intervention axes: • the creation of a Gender Equality Office, tasked with data collection, monitoring and annual reporting on academic career development and performance in research-innovation by gender, as well as with raising awareness and constantly promoting gender equality at all levels of the organization • the training of a number of gender equality mentors among professors and doctoral supervisors, mentoring female doctoral students and assistant lecturers/lecturers • exposing all academics and, in particular, university decision-makers to campaigns to raise awareness of gender inequality in academic and research careers • the implementation of a cross-cutting gender studies module involving students from all faculties • supporting gender parity in leadership positions and encouraging women to participate in selection panels in national and international research competitions • creating a parent/women-friendly culture through childcare facilities for staff with such needs • implementing tools to report and combat discrimination and sexual harassment National regulation: National Council for Combating Discrimination https://www.cncd.ro/ is the state authority established in 2001 (Government Decision 1194/2001) in charge of monitoring, preventing, fighting discrimination and providing assistance to persons discriminated against based on their gender, age, ethnic, national or social origin, religion, sexual orientation, disability, political opinion. Government Act 137/2000 https://www.cncd.ro/wp-content/uploads/2021/02/og-nr.-137-din-2000-republicata-2014.pdf and its modifications regarding sanctioning of all forms of discrimination Law. 202/2002 on equal opportunities and treatment of men and women Proposals: Action Plan, Action 9

Status**11. Evaluation/ appraisal systems**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented		Current practice: In accordance with the documents and legislative provisions elaborated in Romania by the institutions responsible for monitoring and legislating the scientific and research activity, the recognition of research activity aims to increase the quality, impact and international visibility of Romanian research. (Link) https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/Procedura-operationala-privind-recompensarea-rezultatelor-cercetarii-incepand-cu-01-iunie-2023-7.pdf The rewarding of significant results published in prestigious journals of the main international scientific stream is realized through the adoption of a procedure at university level. It is addressed to researchers affiliated to the institution, full professors, teaching and non-teaching staff, PhD students, master's students and students, authors of scientific articles published in journals indexed by Clarivate Analytics in Science Citation Index Expanded ("Science"), Social Sciences Citation Index ("Social Sciences"), Arts & Humanities Citation Index ("Arts & Humanities") or Emerging Sources Citation Index (ESCI), in journals indexed in SCOPUS, in conference proceedings indexed by Clarivate Analytics in Conference Proceeding Citation Index. Academic staff are rewarded in accordance with the legal provisions on salary rights in Romania, and the amounts due for the rewarding of students, master's and doctoral students are awarded in the form of scholarships. The procedure by which ULBS rewards the scientific results of excellence obtained from the research-development activity finalized with the publication of scientific articles is applied through SSCDI. According to the mentioned procedure, our administrative structure is responsible for data processing, verifying the authenticity of the data in the statements requesting the award. The award application is accompanied by supporting documents and endorsed by the academic and administrative structures of the university. Annually, approximately 600 award applications are processed, with a monthly average of 50 applications.

Recruitment and Selection - please be aware that the items listed here correspond with the Charter and Code. In addition, your organisation also needs to complete the checklist on Open, Transparent and Merit-based Recruitment included in a separate section, which focuses on the operationalization of these principles.

Status

12. Recruitment

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	The current recruitment process lacks full transparency and inclusiveness, as it excludes part-time and grant-funded positions, does not provide information in English, and limits international participation. The absence of external evaluators and systematic feedback further reduces impartiality, fairness, and alignment with international best practices.	Current practice: All positions are filled through an open competition process that adheres to the internal regulations of ULBS, as established by Senate Decision no. 3849/23.09.2022. https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/230922/6_Metodologia%20de%20concurs%20PDC_Senat_sept2022.pdf This framework aligns with national legislation and emphasizes principles of transparency, non-discrimination, equal opportunities, and quality standards. However, the current recruitment methodology excludes vacant teaching positions remunerated on an hourly basis and vacant research positions within research and development grants. Detailed information regarding available positions is initially published in the Monitorul Oficial al României, Part III, followed by announcements disseminated through mass media and the official ULBS website, https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/ where dedicated sections organize postings by field and position type. Each competition is accompanied by a dedicated folder containing the application form, the official announcement (detailing job responsibilities, general and specific requirements), the required bibliography, a list of candidate documents, dates for the written test and interview, and the location for submitting application files. Throughout the selection process, communications concerning application evaluations, written test and interview results, as well as final decisions, are systematically added. Feedback related to reasons for rejection is provided at each stage. The institution ensures equality of opportunity for all candidates in accordance with Law. 202/2002 http://www.mmuncii.ro/j33/images/Documente/Legislatie/L202-2002-R.pdf on equal opportunities and treatment of men and women, as well as the ULBS Code of Conduct https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/111220/2_Regulament%20de%20ordine%20interioara_Senat_dec2020.pdf which specifically addresses equal treatment between genders. The current recruitment methodology does not cover part-time teaching positions paid by the hour or research posts funded through grants, resulting in gaps in transparency and consistency throughout the hiring process. Additionally, recruitment announcements and related documentation are not made available in English, which limits the institution's international visibility and restricts access for candidates who do not speak Romanian. In some competitions, the requirement of a fixed bibliography as part of the selection process may disadvantage external or international applicants and constrains merit-based evaluation. Furthermore, there is no formal obligation to include external or international evaluators in selection committees, which may compromise impartiality and hinder alignment with international best practices. Finally, feedback is currently provided only in cases of rejection, rather than systematically after each stage for all candidates, potentially affecting the perceived fairness and transparency of the process as well as candidate development. Suggestions for improvement: To address the identified gaps, the recruitment methodology should be extended to include part-time teaching positions and research posts funded through grants, with clear rules ensuring transparency, fair selection, and effective communication, all aligned with the OTM-R principles. It is recommended to make the translation of all recruitment announcements and related documentation into English mandatory to facilitate international recruitment and broaden accessibility. The bibliography requirements should be reviewed and made more flexible by offering alternative options, placing greater emphasis on candidates' relevant skills and experience rather than rote memorization. Furthermore, the inclusion of external and/or international evaluators in selection committees should be mandated to enhance impartiality and ensure alignment with European best practices. Finally, the feedback process must be standardized so that all candidates receive detailed, justified feedback after each stage of the recruitment process, thereby increasing transparency and fostering candidate development. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 7 Action Plan, Action 8 Action Plan, Action 10

Status**13. Recruitment (Code)**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	Job advertisements and documentation are currently published only in Romanian, which limits international accessibility and reduces the potential to attract foreign researchers. Additionally, although visibility is strong at the national level, no structured strategy is in place to reach international candidates or EURAXESS.	Current practice: ULBS ensures wide dissemination of job advertisements by using multiple national platforms, including the Monitorul Oficial al României, jobs.edu.ro, jobs.research.gov.ro, https://jobs.mcid.gov.ro , BestJobs, and posturi.gov.ro, as well as the university's official website and the platform Euraxess. This practice enhances visibility and accessibility of research and academic positions at national level. Suggestion for improvement: To align with the Code of Conduct for the Recruitment of Researchers and enhance international openness, ULBS should translate job advertisements and supporting documents into English and ensure their dissemination through more international platforms. This would increase the institution's global reach and support open, transparent, and merit-based recruitment (OTM-R) in line with European standards. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 7 Action Plan, Action 8 Action Plan, Action 10

14. Selection (Code)

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	ULBS's commitment to transparent and merit-based recruitment is already strong, but fully aligning with the European Charter and Code will require overcoming significant challenges. The most pressing impediments include bureaucratic rigidity, resource limitations, cultural resistance to change, and the need for enhanced inclusivity mechanisms.	Current Practice: ULBS employs a structured selection process for teaching and research positions, ensuring transparency through public announcements on the university website at least 48 hours in advance and publishing exam topics 45 days prior, with final topics selected by lot. The process is competitive, evaluating candidates via standardized stages (file verification, written exams, public lectures) using GRADIS https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/gradis/ /SIEPAS https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/platforma-siepas/ systems for merit-based assessment. Selection committees, appointed by the Rector and approved by the University Senate and Faculty Council, consist of up to 5 members who verify compliance and evaluate performance. Criteria are tailored to academic levels, requiring doctoral degrees and specific experience, aligned with approved curricula. An appeals committee ensures fairness, and decisions are formalized with documented reports. Furthermore, ULBS ensures a transparent and merit-based selection process for the grant competition by publishing the list of eligible grant proposals on the Research-Development-Innovation Service website and allowing appeals on eligibility via email. The evaluation is competitive, involving at least three internationally recognized UEFISCDI experts, unaffiliated with ULBS, who independently assess eligible proposals for quality based on the director's scientific excellence (40%) and project quality (60%). Experts declare impartiality, confidentiality, and competence in writing, with a mechanism to report conflicts of interest. Proposals are ranked by final scores within three research domains, ensuring a structured and merit-based prioritization within the allocated budget. Suggestions for Improvement: ULBS should diversify the composition of the initial eligibility evaluation committee, currently limited to three senior ULBS officials (Prorector, Head of Research Service, and Director of Knowledge Transfer Centre), by including external or diverse members (e.g., gender balance, international experts) to enhance impartiality. Additionally, ULBS should also implement accommodations for candidates with disabilities and provide multilingual support for international applicants. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 8 Action Plan, Action 10

Status

15. Transparency (Code)

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	Government Decision 1336/2022 establishes the elements to be included in the vacancy announcements.	Current practice The process of filling teaching, research, and auxiliary positions at Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu (ULBS) complies with the principles of transparency, equal opportunity, and conformity with national legislation. Vacancy announcements are published: • on the official ULBS website, in the Vacancies section -Link, https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/despre/organizare/cariera/ • on the national platform posturi.gov.ro, https://posturi.gov.ro/?sfid=80 • on the European portal EURAXESS https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/jobs for positions with an international component, • and, where required by law, in the Official Gazette of Romania (e.g., management positions or teaching positions with certain special conditions). The announcements include the essential elements (the position offered, minimum requirements, documents, evaluation criteria, schedule, topics/tests, appeal channels), and before applying, candidates can explicitly consult the selection stages and criteria. For project-based positions, the requirements of the funders (e.g., UEFISCDI, Horizon Europe/PNRR) are followed, in addition to ULBS internal rules, so that the process is open and verifiable. Personal data is processed in accordance with the GDPR. According to Government Decision No. 1336/2022 https://www.mmuncii.ro/j33/images/Documente/Legislatie/HG_1336_2022.pdf (a national law that sets out the mandatory elements for job ads in higher education), all ads include: the job title, the conditions for getting the job, the competition topics, the deadlines, and the list of required documents. At the institutional level, the ULBS Senate approved, by Decision No. 2481/26.05.2023 https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/260523/17_PO-ULBS-SRU-05_Senat_mai2023.pdf, the Operational Procedure for filling contractual teaching and non-teaching positions, which details the stages of the selection process, the composition of the committees, the evaluation criteria, the methods of publishing and archiving the results, as well as the mechanisms for informing candidates. For competitions related to research projects (e.g., UEFISCDI, Horizon Europe, PNRR), the recruitment process complies with the requirements of the funders' guidelines and is correlated with ULBS internal regulations, such as the Operational Procedure for the Selection of Management Team Members for Project Implementation, https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/060325/9_PO%20Selectia%20membrilor%20echipelor%20de%20management%20implementare%20proiecte_Senat_martie2025.pdf ensuring transparency and compliance with international standards. Currently, Romanian law does not require individual feedback to be provided to each candidate after the selection process, but competition committees may decide to provide such feedback. All competitions and their results are archived on the ULBS website, ensuring traceability and public access to information. Internal regulations • Operational procedure for filling contractual teaching and non-teaching positions – approved by ULBS Senate Decision No. 2481/26.05.2023: Link https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/260523/17_PO-ULBS-SRU-05_Senat_mai2023.pdf • Competition methodology for filling teaching and research positions 2024-2025: Link https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/ca/2022/Anexa%201%20-%20Metodologie_de_concurs_PDC_cu_antet_09.09.2022.pdf • Operational procedure – selection of members of management/implementation teams for projects financed from external funds: Link https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/060325/9_PO%20Selectia%20membrilor%20echipelor%20de%20management%20implementare%20proiecte_Senat_martie2025.pdf • ULBS Charter: Link https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta%20ULBS%202025_Proiect.pdf • Labor Code (Law No. 53/2003, republished, with subsequent amendments) – official text available on the legislative portal: Link https://www.mmuncii.ro/j33/images/Documente/Legislatie/2018/2018-04-13_legea-53din2003-republicata-Codul_Muncii.pdf • Government Decision No. 1336/2022 on filling positions in higher education: Link https://www.mmuncii.ro/j33/images/Documente/Legislatie/HG_1336_2022.pdf • ARACIS Methodology – Standard A.3.1 (Human Resources) requiring transparency in the selection process: Link https://www.aracis.ro/wp-content/uploads/2024/08/HG-962_2024-Metodologia-ARACIS.pdf Suggestions for improvement • Sending an official letter from the committee to each candidate, containing the strengths and weaknesses identified during the evaluation. • Using a standardized feedback form, with sections for each evaluation criterion, so that the response is objective and consistent. • Include personalized recommendations for improving future applications. • Publish the evaluation grids: attach the grid with the criteria/weightings used by the committee to the announcement; after the competition, publish the list of aggregate scores (anonymized for rejected candidates). Proposals: Action Plan, Action 7 Action Plan, Action 8 Action Plan, Action 10

Status

16. Judging merit (Code)

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented	Current practice At Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu (ULBS), the process of evaluating candidates for teaching, research, and support positions is based on clear, transparent, and public criteria: • Competition announcements include eligibility criteria so that each candidate can assess whether they meet the requirements of the position. The official ULBS career and job vacancies page centralises these announcements (Link) https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/despre/organizare/cariera/ • Competition committees are required to develop an evaluation grid for written and practical tests and an interview plan, in accordance with the Operational Procedure for Filling Positions approved by Senate Decision No. 2481/26.05.2023 (Link) https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/260523/17_PO-ULBS-SRU-05_Senat_mai2023.pdf These assessment tools are communicated to candidates to ensure objectivity and transparency. • The CV and career plan (which include teaching, research, team coordination, and project involvement) are a mandatory part of the application file for teaching and research positions. • The evaluation takes into account both quantitative criteria (number of published articles, indexing, grants attracted) and qualitative criteria (research impact, interdisciplinary contributions, mentoring activity). • In addition to the selection criteria applicable in competitions for teaching and research positions, ULBS applies the procedure for awarding merit grades annually, according to the methodology established by the Ministry of Education and approved by the ULBS Senate. Merit grades are awarded based on the evaluation of performance in scientific research, teaching, grant coordination, involvement in projects, and contributions to academic and institutional development. These constitute formal recognition of the merits of teaching and research staff, providing an additional incentive for excellence (Link) https://drive.google.com/file/d/1YISn37TwoYyZZk7UbBnr84GjUbSHnlv9/view • For advanced research positions (level R3 – experienced researcher and R4 – research team leader), the evaluation complies with the minimum standards approved by CNATDCU for promotion and competitions for grade II and I scientific researcher positions. These criteria include both quantitative indicators (ISI publications, citations, grants attracted, patents) and qualitative aspects regarding the impact and relevance of the research. • For competitions related to research projects (UEFISCDI, Horizon Europe, PNRR), the selection criteria comply with the guidelines of the funders and are correlated with the internal regulations of ULBS, including the Procedure for the selection of management teams for projects, approved in March 2025. (Link) https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/060325/9_PO%20Selectia%20membrilor%20echipelor%20de%20management%20implementare%20proiecte_Senat_martie2025.pdf Internal regulations: • Operational procedure for filling positions (Senate Decision No. 2481/26.05.2023) – • Operational procedure for selecting members of management teams for project implementation (ULBS Senate, March 2025) – (Link) https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/060325/9_PO%20Selectia%20membrilor%20echipelor%20de%20management%20implementare%20proiecte_Senat_martie2025.pdf • Operational procedure for the evaluation of ULBS staff for the purpose of awarding merit grades - (Link) https://drive.google.com/file/d/1YISn37TwoYyZZk7UbBnr84GjUbSHnlv9/view • ULBS Charter 2025 – (Link) https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta%20ULBS%202025_Proiect.pdf • Minimum national standards required and mandatory as proposed by CNATDCU - (Link) https://www.edu.ro/cons_pub_28_2024_propunerii_CNATDCU_standarde_minimale • ARACIS Methodology (Standard A.3.1 – Human resources and transparency in evaluation) – (Link) https://www.aracis.ro/wp-content/uploads/2024/08/HG-962_2024-Metodologia-ARACIS.pdf

Status**17. Variations in the chronological order of CVs (Code)**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	While ULBS recognizes diverse career paths and plans training to address potential bias, there is no formalized mechanism or standardized guidelines to ensure consistent, unbiased evaluation of non-linear CVs. As a result, candidates with unconventional or interrupted career trajectories may still face unequal assessment in practice.	Current practice: ULBS aligns its recruitment and selection procedures with national legislation promoting non-discrimination and career inclusiveness. According to the National Plan for Research, Development and Innovation 2022-2027, https://www.mcid.gov.ro/wp-content/uploads/2022/12/hg-aprobare-pncdi-iv.pdf career development is supported through a predictable and excellence-driven ecosystem. Government Decision 582/2016 recognizes seniority in education as encompassing time spent under employment contracts in research, education, or relevant fields, including periods of parental leave and military service. Law 199/2023 https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocument/271898 further strengthens this framework by prohibiting discriminatory criteria based on seniority or institutional/national origin in recruitment processes. In practice, ULBS ensures that the total work experience of candidates with non-traditional or cross-sectoral career paths is fully acknowledged when determining salary levels, without penalization for not having followed a conventional academic trajectory. Furthermore, the university acknowledges that unconscious bias may influence the evaluation of candidates with discontinuous careers, such as those with gaps due to caregiving, professional shifts, or international mobility. To address this ULBS is committed to implementing dedicated training for members of selection committees, sensitizing them to the diversity of career paths and encouraging an inclusive evaluation of skills and competencies that may not follow a linear or traditional academic progression. Suggestions for improvement: ULBS should develop and institutionalize structured unconscious bias training for all selection committee members, with a particular focus on recognizing and valuing diverse career trajectories, including those involving career breaks, interdisciplinary work, or transitions between academia and industry. Furthermore, it is recommended that the university adopt a narrative CV model or allow applicants to include contextual explanations of their career paths, thereby enabling more nuanced and equitable assessments. Lastly, the implementation of monitoring mechanisms to evaluate the impact of these measures on selection outcomes would enhance transparency and alignment with HRS4R principles. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 8 Action Plan, Action 10

Status**18. Recognition of mobility experience (Code)**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented		Current practice According to Higher Education Law No. 199/2023 (Link), https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocument/271898 professional experience gained through academic or research mobility is recognized as seniority in work and education, if justified by a legal document (employment contract, research contract, institutional agreement). At the level of the "Lucian Blaga" University of Sibiu (ULBS): • Mobility experience (Erasmus+, https://international.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/Erasmus_charter_2021-2027.pdf Horizon Europe, bilateral mobility, postdoctoral internships) is recognized as professional activity and is taken into account in annual and periodic evaluations through the GRADIS system (the tool for evaluating teaching and scientific activity). • Within GRADIS, mobility is classified according to criteria relating to professional development, with points awarded for participation as a keynote speaker, scientific presentations at international conferences, academic exchanges, and research internships (GRADIS – ULBS Regulations). https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/gradis/ • Erasmus+ mobility and international cooperation are supported by the ULBS International Relations Department, which ensures the implementation of programs and the official recognition of activities carried out abroad (ULBS mobility). https://international.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/Internationalization_Strategy_2021_2027.pdf Internal regulations: • GRADIS Regulation (approved by the ULBS Senate, May 2023) – (Link) https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/gradis/ • ULBS Charter (2025) – (Link) https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta%20ULBS%202025_Proiect.pdf • Higher Education Law No. 199/2023 – (Link) https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocument/271898 • Mobility methodology – International Relations Department of Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu - (Link) https://international.ulbsibiu.ro/ • Methodology regarding the mobility of ULBS doctoral students - (Link) https://doctorate.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/18_Metodologie-mobilitati-studenti-doctoranzi_Senat_iulie2024.pdf • Policy statements and Erasmus+ Charter - (Link) https://international.ulbsibiu.ro/erasmus/policy-statements-and-erasmus-charter/ Suggestions for improvement: • Increase the visibility of mobility results (reports, post-mobility workshops, public presentations) to multiply the effects at the institutional level.

Status

19. Recognition of qualifications (Code)

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented		Current practice Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu (ULBS) has implemented clear mechanisms for the recognition of academic and professional qualifications, in accordance with national and European legislation, to ensure transparency and mobility of academic and research staff. • National legal framework: o Higher Education Law No. 199/2023 regulates the recognition and equivalence of studies, diplomas, and qualifications obtained abroad (Link). https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocument/271898 o Recognition at national level is carried out by CNRED – the National Center for the Recognition and Equivalence of Diplomas (CNRED). https://cnred.edu.ro/en/recognition-of-professional-experience-and-of-qualifications-acquired-abroad/ o For academic and research positions, the minimum eligibility criteria established by CNATDCU https://www.edu.ro/cons_pub_28_2024_propuneri_CNATDCU_standarde_minimale for R3/R4 degrees (associate professor/university professor) also apply. • Institutional framework at ULBS: o The university applies operational procedures for the automatic recognition of certain degrees obtained abroad: § Automatic recognition of the status of doctoral supervisor, in accordance with MENCŞ No. 5921/2016 (text of the Order https://www.edu.ro/sites/default/files/fisiere%20articole/ORDIN_5921_2016.pdf; ULBS procedure https://doctorate.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/11_Metodologia-privind-recunoasterea-automata-a-calitatii-de-conducator-de-doctorat_Senat_sept2024.pdf). § Automatic recognition of doctoral degrees, according to MENCŞ no. 5923/2016 (text of the Order https://www.edu.ro/sites/default/files/fisiere%20articole/ORDIN_5923_2016_0.pdf; ULBS procedure). https://doctorate.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/6_Metodologie-recunoasterea-diplomei-de-doctor_Senat_oct2024.pdf o These procedures have legal effect within ULBS and allow: § participation in competitions for teaching and research positions; § participation in competition committees for academic positions; § evaluation and defense of doctoral theses; § assumption of roles as guest professors in teaching and research activities. • Recognition in evaluations and promotions: o The GRADIS system (Regulation 2023) includes explicit recognition of international mobility, diplomas, and certifications obtained abroad, scoring both teaching and research components. o At doctoral level, IOSUD-ULBS (link) recognises studies carried out at partner universities through Erasmus+, CEEPUS, Horizon Europe agreements or within the European FORTHM alliance, as part of doctoral training and the development of teaching staff skills. Internal regulations: • ULBS Charter 2025 – articles on the recognition of studies and staff recruitment (Link). https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta%20ULBS%202025_Proiect.pdf • GRADIS Regulation (2023) – evaluation and scoring of international qualifications and experience (Link). https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/gradis/ • ULBS procedure for the recognition of qualifications – in accordance with OMENCS 5921/2016 (Link). https://doctorate.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/11_Metodologia-privind-recunoasterea-automata-a-calitatii-de-conducator-de-doctorat_Senat_sept2024.pdf • ULBS procedure for the recognition of doctoral degrees – in accordance with OMENCS 5923/2016 (Link). https://doctorate.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/6_Metodologie-recunoasterea-diplomei-de-doctor_Senat_oct2024.pdf

Status

20. Seniority (Code)

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented		Current practice At ULBS, access to doctoral programs and senior academic positions is achieved through public competition, based on skills and results, not formal seniority or the prestige of the institution of origin. The ULBS Charter (2025) https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/260625/2_CARTA%20ULBS_Senat_iunie2025.pdf sets out the general principles for the recruitment, evaluation, and promotion of teaching and research staff, guaranteeing equal and transparent access to positions and recognition of professional experience. Admission to doctoral studies is regulated annually by IOSUD-ULBS: for 2025–2026, the admission regulations are published on the IOSUD-ULBS website (section "Legislation") - Link https://doctorate.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/9_Regulamentul-de-admitere-la-studii-universitare-de-doctorat_Senat_ian2025.pdf; and Annex 12 https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/250724/19_Anexa%2012%20Criterii%20de%20admitere%20IOSUD%20_Senat_iulie2024.pdf – Admission Criteria was updated in July 2024. These documents refer to the Framework Regulation for Doctoral Studies (OM 3020/2024) and clarify eligibility, tests, and evaluation criteria (Link). https://www.edu.ro/sites/default/files/fisiere%20articole/OM_3020-2024.pdf The ULBS regulations governing the organization and conduct of doctoral studies were revised in 2024 (repealing the 2022 version). They define the role of CSUD/doctoral schools and detail the selection/conduct of studies, without introducing seniority barriers beyond those required by law (Link). https://doctorate.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/Final-Regulament-organizare-desfasurare-studii-doctorale-2024.pdf The evaluation of academic progress and seniority is carried out through GRADIS https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/GRADIS-conform-Hotararii-de-Senat-nr-2739-din-14.06.2023, the internal academic performance evaluation system, and by applying the CNATDCU criteria for senior teaching and research positions. These take into account both quantitative aspects (publications, grants) and qualitative aspects (research impact, collaborations, involvement in project management) (Link). https://www.cnatdcu.ro/wp-content/uploads/2015/12/Anexe.pdf Internal regulations: • ULBS Charter – chapters on competitions, HR policies, and IOSUD/CSUD organization – Link. https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/260625/2_CARTA%20ULBS_Senat_iunie2025.pdf • ULBS Regulations on Doctoral Studies (2024) – June/Oct. 2024 versions (repealing Reg. 2022) – Link. https://doctorate.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/Final-Regulament-organizare-desfasurare-studii-doctorale-2024.pdf • Regulations/Announcements for doctoral admission 2025–2026 – IOSUD-ULBS Legislation section; Annex 12 – Admission criteria (July 2024) – Link. https://doctorate.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/legislatie/ • GRADIS (May 2023) – evaluation of teaching/scientific activity (includes scoring of mobility and results) - Link. https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/GRADIS-conform-Hotararii-de-Senat-nr-2739-din-14.06.2023 • Law 183/2024 – status of research staff, with rules on employment, promotion, and evaluation – Link. https://legislatie.just.ro/public/DetaliuDocument/283972 • OM 3020/2024 – Framework regulation on doctoral studies – Link. https://www.edu.ro/sites/default/files/fisiere%20articole/OM_3020-2024.pdf

Status

21. Postdoctoral appointments (Code)

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented		Current practice: At Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu, postdoctoral programs are implemented through nationally and European-funded research projects (UEFISCDI – PNCDI IV, Horizon Europe, PNRR, Marie Skłodowska-Curie European scholarships, etc.). Positions are filled through public competition, based on open and transparent selection calls, in compliance with national legislation and ULBS internal procedures. Within IOSUD-ULBS, postdoctoral researchers are encouraged to affiliate themselves with research centers and laboratories, participate in multidisciplinary projects, and develop their academic careers. Postdoctoral experience is recognized as professional seniority and is a valuable criterion in subsequent evaluations for teaching and research positions. In addition, the ULBS Charter (2025) and the National Research, Development, and Innovation Plan IV (2023–2026) provide support for young researchers and the development of postdoctoral programs, with an emphasis on mobility and internationalization. Internal regulations: • ULBS Charter (2025) – chapters on filling academic positions and recognizing professional seniority – Link. https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/Carta%20ULBS%202025_Proiect.pdf • IOSUD-ULBS Regulation (2024) – regulates the organization of doctoral studies and the integration of postdoctoral researchers into ULBS research activities – Link. https://doctorate.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/4_Regulament-organizare-si-desf-a-studiilor-univ-doctorat_Senat_oct2024-final.pdf • CDI project procedures – filling postdoctoral positions funded by projects (UEFISCDI, Horizon Europe, PNRR) is done in accordance with ULBS procedures on research project management – Link. https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/infrastructura-de-cercetare/proiecte-de-cercetare/proceduri-si-regulamente-proiecte-de-cercetare/ • Law 199/2023 on Higher Education (link) and Law 183/2024 on the status of research and development personnel establish the legal framework for filling positions and recognizing postdoctoral periods – Link. https://legislatie.just.ro/public/DetaliuDocument/283972

Working Conditions and Social Security

Status

22. Recognition of the profession

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented		Current practice: National regulation: The National Authority for Research (NRA) is the state authority with the role of regulation, representation, coordination, synthesis and control in the field of research, development and innovation and with the tasks of ensuring the implementation of Law no. 183/2024 on the status of research, development and innovation personnel. (Link https://www.research.gov.ro/sistemul-de-cercetare/promovarea-in-grad-profesional-a-cercetatorilor-stiintifici-cs-i-si-cs-ii/) Job placement and career advancement CDI staff shall be recruited by open competition or examination, taking into account the principles of transparency, competence and gender equality. The research organization is responsible for the appointment and career advancement. The file containing the documents related to the competition for the position of CS II or CS I, respectively those related to the promotion examination for obtaining the professional grade of CS II or CS I, carried out in research organizations, other than higher education institutions and institutes / branches of the Romanian Academy, is transmitted in electronic format to the NCA for analysis and evaluation, after the completion of the competition / examination and after obtaining the opinion of the branch academy, provided for in art. 10 para. (5) of Law 183/2024, if applicable. The Consultative College for Research-Development and Innovation (CCCDI) is the main specialized advisory body, without legal personality, of the NCA, and carries out its activity in accordance with the provisions of Government Ordinance no. 57/2002 on scientific research and technological development, approved with amendments and additions by Law no. 324/2003, with subsequent amendments and additions. The CCCDI verifies and gives its opinion according to the fulfilment of the minimum standards by the candidate declared winner of the competition for the position of CS II or CS I, respectively for the promotion examination for obtaining the professional grade of CS II or CS I, carried out in research organizations, other than higher education institutions and institutes / branches of the Romanian Academy, unless the candidate declared winner of the competition holds the professional grade of research and development corresponding to the position for which he/she applied.

Status**23. Research environment**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented		Current practice: ULBS has been the recipient of the largest private donation of 5 millions euro by the Hasso Plattner Foundation that allowed the investment in the upgrade of ULBS Research Centers equipment and facilities. A specific methodology has been in place for the allocation of the amounts among the various entities of the ULBS in order for them to buy new equipment. (Link) https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/proceduri-si-regulamente/activitati-proiecte-finantate-prin-parteneriatul-ulbs-hasso-plattner-2019/ The Research, Development, and Innovation Strategy of Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu 2025 - 2034 (Link) https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/Strategia-ULBS-2025-2034-2.pdf The Research, Development, and Innovation Strategy of Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu is based on three fundamental principles: ● Quality over quantity: ULBS promotes excellence in research, encouraging innovative approaches and results with real impact, rather than simply accumulating data to tick scientometric indicators. ● International and transdisciplinary research networks: ULBS supports collaboration between researchers specializing in various fields of knowledge and coming from various institutions, as the pooling of human and material resources can lead to higher levels of performance. ● Transferring research results to the socio-economic environment: ULBS aims to capitalize on the scientific discoveries made within the institution by applying them in industry, economics, administration, society, and culture. The academic culture of ULBS is defined by a set of fundamental values that guide all research activity at the university: ● Performance and integrity: ULBS promotes research of the highest quality, based on ethical standards, rigor, and transparency, with the aim of producing relevant and impactful scientific contributions. ● Innovation and creativity: ULBS encourages new ideas, critical thinking, and revolutionary solutions that can transform challenges into opportunities. ● Socio-economic relevance: ULBS supports the application of research results in industry and society, promoting strategic partnerships and contributing to the development of technological and innovative solutions. ● Interdisciplinarity and collaboration: ULBS believes in the power of connections between different scientific fields and in the importance of working in multidisciplinary teams, including within international research networks. ● Responsibility and sustainability: ULBS assumes responsibility for contributing to a sustainable future through research focused on sustainable development, environmental protection, and community well-being. ● Openness to the world: ULBS supports researcher mobility, the constant exchange of ideas, and participation in large-scale collaborative projects as ways to confirm its position in the international research arena.

Status

24. Working conditions

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	The standard 40-hour workweek lacks provisions for flexible or part-time arrangements, which may not suit the irregular schedules often required for research projects. Despite modern infrastructure, there are no clear policies or resources (e.g., remote access tools, home office stipends) to support remote or hybrid work, a growing need post-COVID. The rigid schedule and lack of flexible options may hinder researchers' ability to balance professional commitments with personal responsibilities.	Current practice: ULBS ensures safe working conditions through its Internal Regulations of Order (ROI), Article 10 and 14, which mandate health and safety compliance per Romanian labor laws. The university provides a standard 40-hour workweek (Art. 17, ROI) and access to modern facilities, including laboratories, libraries, and IT infrastructure across its 21 research centers. The University Charter (Art. 82-83) outlines workplace provisions, such as office space and equipment, supporting research activities. Health protection is addressed through institutional insurance and safety protocols, though specific measures for researchers (e.g., ergonomic workstations) are not detailed. Flexibility is limited to the standard schedule, with no explicit provisions for remote work or adjusted hours to accommodate research demands. At Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu (ULBS), the current status of Principle "Working Conditions," reflects compliance with safe and supportive environments through adherence to Romanian labor laws, ensuring health protection and a standard 40-hour workweek. The university provides access to modern facilities, such as laboratories and IT systems, across its 21 research centers. However, specific measures for ergonomic support or remote work are not detailed, resulting in limited flexibility for researcher. Suggestions for Improvement: ● Introduce Flexible Work Arrangements: Develop policies allowing researchers to adjust their 40-hour workweek, including part-time options or flexible hours, to accommodate research cycles and personal needs. ● Formalize Remote Work Policies: Establish a remote work framework, providing necessary equipment (e.g., laptops, software licenses) and guidelines for hybrid work, ensuring equitable access across departments. ● Enhance Health and Safety Support: Implement ergonomic assessments for workstations and offer mental health resources (e.g., counseling services) specifically for researchers, addressing long-term well-being. ● Standardize Facility Access: Conduct an audit of research facilities to ensure consistent access to modern equipment and address overcrowding, with a plan to upgrade under-resourced areas. ● Promote Work-Life Balance: Introduce policies such as parental leave extensions or reduced teaching loads for researchers with caregiving responsibilities, aligning with HRS4R standards. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 11

25. Stability and permanence of employment

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented		Current practice: According to the Romanian Labor Code (Law 53/2003) https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocumentAfis/41625 and ULBS's internal competition regulations https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/230922/6_Metodologia%20de%20concurs%20PDC_Senat_sept2022.pdf , employment contracts for teaching and research staff are generally established for an indefinite period, especially for positions such as lecturer, associate professor, professor, or senior research staff. Fixed-term employment contracts are permitted only in cases explicitly regulated by law, such as temporary replacement of staff, increased workload, or time-limited research projects. At Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu, most teaching and research positions are filled on a permanent basis through public competitions. However, positions such as teaching assistant, junior researcher, and early-stage research positions (e.g., Researcher Grade III) may be opened either on a permanent or fixed-term basis (maximum 3 years). Additionally, doctoral students may be employed on a fixed-term basis of up to 5 years, according to the institutional competition methodology, https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/230922/6_Metodologia%20de%20concurs%20PDC_Senat_sept2022.pdf based on Article 294 of Law 1/2011. https://www.edu.ro/sites/default/files/_fi%C8%99iere/Legislatie/2020/LEN_actualizata_octombrie_2020.pdf Exceptions apply mainly to project-based research roles, which are not governed by this methodology and are instead subject to the specific provisions of the grant agreements. Such contracts are typically time-bound and limited to the project duration, varying between a few months and up to 5 years..

Status**26. Funding and salaries**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented		Current practice: Depending on the funding source, the remuneration for research activities varies. However, the hourly rates are competitive and attractive, often exceeding the minimum threshold of the average gross salary at national level. For senior researchers and those in project management roles, the remuneration can reach up to 50 EUR/hour, depending on the complexity and funding of the project. In addition, researchers benefit from full coverage under the national social security system, as all mandatory contributions are withheld and paid directly by the university as an employer. This ensures full protection in cases of sickness, parental leave, pension rights, and unemployment, in accordance with applicable Romanian legislation.

27. Gender balance

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	The dedicated online page for the Bureau of Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion lacks any information about its activities, objectives, or progress in implementing the Gender Equality Plan. This absence of transparency and accessibility hinders stakeholder engagement and awareness, creating a gap in ULBS' gender balance.	Current practice: The National Agency for Equal Opportunities between Women and Men https://anes.gov.ro/ is the governmental body responsible for implementing and monitoring the gender equality strategy. At the national level, the equality in treatment of men and women is regulated through the Law. 202/2002 https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocument/35778 The gender equality is further addressed in the Law 178/2018 https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocumentAfis/202771 that introduces definitions and attributions of gender equality technicians and experts to be appointed within organizations with more than 50 employees. ULBS has adopted a Gender Equality Plan https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/161221/9_Planul%20privind%20egalitatea%20de%20gen_Senat_16.12.2021.pdf (GEP) on 16th December 2021 in line with national and European regulations introducing several proposed measures to tackle inequalities among students, administrative and research staff, and to ensure gender balance at all managerial levels. Following these measures, the University has adopted the decision 4344/28.09.2023 for the creation of a Bureau for equity, diversity and inclusion https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/280923/18_Nota%20de%20fundamentare%20cu%20privire%20la%20Organigrama%20ULBS_Senat_sept2023.pdf subordinated to the Vice-rector responsible for the relationship with students and the community. This newly should establish structure will implement the actions of the GEP, including monitoring and evaluation of gender equality in career promotion, the awareness-raising about gender inequality among all university staff, and the training of mentors for equality among PhD directors. It is expected that early statistics regarding gender balance at all management levels as well as in respect to students' enrollment in STEM will be produced by the Bureau for equity, diversity and inclusion. Suggestions for Improvement: To address the current lack of transparency and accessibility, the Bureau of Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion should develop its dedicated webpage to include the Gender Equality Plan, objectives, actions, and timelines, as well as regular updates on implementation. Progress reports and statistics on gender balance in management, staff, and student enrollment should be published annually. The Bureau should also provide information on awareness-raising activities, training sessions, and contact points for gender equality experts, ensuring visibility, stakeholder engagement, and alignment with national and European requirements. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 1 Action Plan, Action 5 Action Plan, Action 7

Status**28. Career development**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	The initiative is project-based rather than permanent, with uneven visibility and accessibility across faculties. It does not yet address critical areas such as grant writing, networking, and employability skills training, which are essential for long-term career success and institutional competitiveness.	Current Status: ULBS supports researchers through the COCerc, offering confidential, tailored counseling across all career stages (students to postdocs). Services include individual sessions, career needs assessments, self-evaluation tools, and structured development planning. ULBS provides a structured support system for researchers through the COCerc https://grants.ulbsibiu.ro/cocerc/category/cocerc/ (Career Orientation Center for Researchers) project. The initiative delivers personalized career counseling services tailored to different stages of the research career path, including students, doctoral candidates, and postdoctoral researchers. Current services include career needs assessments, the use of self-evaluation tools, individualized counseling sessions, and career planning guidance. Suggestions for Improvement: ● Institutionalize COCerc as a permanent, university-funded service. ● Strengthen visibility and access through an online presence. ● Broaden services to include grant writing, networking, and career transition training. ● Build partnerships with external stakeholders to align support with labor market needs. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 11

29. Value of mobility

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	Limited funding or structured programs specifically for researcher mobility, potentially restricting international exposure and collaboration opportunities.	Current Status: ULBS participates in international collaborations such as Erasmus+ and the FORTHEM Alliance, which promote student and staff mobility. These programs likely include opportunities for researchers to study or collaborate abroad, but specific funding or incentives for researcher mobility are not highlighted. Mobility is supported through existing programs, but may not be fully incentivized for researchers, especially in terms of intersectoral mobility (e.g., industry partnerships). Suggestions for Improvement: Increase funding for researcher mobility through grants or fellowships and establish partnerships with industry for intersectoral mobility to enhance practical experience and career development. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 10

Status

30. Access to career advice

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	While the initiative is active, it is project-based and not fully institutionalized as a permanent service. The current service does not cover essential career development areas such as grant writing, professional networking, and employability skills training.	Current status: ULBS has developed a dedicated support structure through the COCerc https://grants.ulbsibiu.ro/cocerc/category/cocerc/ (Career Orientation Center for Researchers) project, offering personalized, career counselling for researchers at all levels (students, PhDs, postdocs). Services include: assessment of career needs, self-evaluation tools, individual sessions, and career planning. The program is based on informed consent and follows national and EU data protection regulations. Suggestions for Improvement: ● Transform COCerc into a permanent, institutionally funded career center integrated into ULBS structures; ensure online presence and visibility for all researchers. ● Broaden the scope of career support services at ULBS to systematically include training in grant proposal development, networking strategies, and career transition skills. ● Establish partnerships with external stakeholders (employers, funding bodies, alumni) to align training with labor market needs. ● Integrate impact monitoring tools to assess the effectiveness of career development initiatives. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 11

31. Intellectual Property Rights

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	Although ULBS has internal procedures and emphasizes the importance of protecting intellectual property, specific policies, rights, and management processes are not widely communicated or fully understood by all researchers. There is also a lack of structured training and support mechanisms to ensure consistent application and awareness in research activities.	Current Status: Researchers should be aware of their intellectual property rights and how to protect and manage them in their research activities. Intellectual property, viewed under its two components, industrial property on the one hand and copyright and related rights on the other, is one of the basic levers of current economic, social, and cultural development, its purpose and goal being to protect the product of human intelligence and, at the same time, to guarantee consumers the benefit of using this product. In this context, Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu attaches great importance to the protection of rights over human creations relating to literary, artistic, and scientific works, inventions in all fields, scientific discoveries, and rights related to intellectual activity in the industrial, scientific, literary, and artistic fields. Intellectual property matters at Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu are governed by a series of internal procedures. (Link) http://centers.ulbsibiu.ro/itchpiulbs/ro/proceduri.php ULBS has a focus on innovation and technology transfer, likely through its research centers and partnerships, such as the Hasso Plattner Knowledge Transfer Institute (HPI-ULBS). However, specific policies on intellectual property rights may not be widely communicated or understood by all researchers. (Link) https://centers.ulbsibiu.ro/itchpiulbs/en/organization.php Information regarding intellectual property protection can also be found in the ULBS Charter: Principles and rules of academic ethics and conduct ULBS protects intellectual property rights. ULBS supports the prevention of intellectual property rights infringement. The university applies a zero-tolerance policy toward plagiarism. The academic community is educated in this regard through the introduction of courses on ethics and academic integrity in all ULBS faculties, as well as through the development and dissemination of guidelines and methodologies for good academic practice. In research activities, avoiding plagiarism of any kind and respecting intellectual property rights, including those arising from joint ownership of data in the case of research carried out in collaboration with a supervisor or other researchers; validating new discoveries based on repeating previous research/experiments is acceptable, provided that the data is confirmed and explicitly cited; in scientific publications, the use of the author's own work is permitted, provided that the source is cited and the author's name is mentioned. Academic fraud in bachelor's/master's/doctoral theses will inevitably lead to ULBS requesting the competent courts to revoke the bachelor's/master's/doctoral degree. Depending on the severity of the case, ULBS may take action to publicly restore the infringed intellectual property right, with the aim of correcting the fraudulent attribution of authorship of the work. Suggestions for Improvement: Increasing the awareness through training and workshops on intellectual property rights, and establishing a clear policy for managing research outputs, including patent filing and licensing. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 3 Action Plan, Action 13

Status**32. Co-authorship**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
++ fully implemented		Current practice: Within the "Lucian Blaga" University of Sibiu, both the teaching and the research activity conducted by the teaching staff are annually evaluated. Up until 2021, an Integrated System for Evaluating Academic Performance (SIEPAS) had been employed in this respect, with a new system, focused on performance in teaching and research alike, having been implemented in 2022 (GRADIS). https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/gradis/ Both systems are characterized by supporting co-authorship for researchers, as well as for teaching staff. The points awarded by these systems for publishing a scientific paper, as well as those awarded for a work being cited in a scientific paper, are only divided among the authors from the "Lucian Blaga" University of Sibiu, thus strongly encouraging collaboration with other researchers from other institutions and affiliations in the country and abroad. The same strategy is also applied for patents. At a national scale, the National Council for Financing Upper Education (CNFIS) rewards excellence in research, using the same methodology (i.e., dividing the total points obtained because of research activity to the total number of authors from Romania) when evaluating such research activity, thus encouraging co-authorship and international collaboration. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 1:

33. Teaching

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	There is no structured, institution-wide framework for continuous teaching development, and professional growth largely depends on project-based or externally funded training opportunities. Additionally, evaluation indicators emphasize quantitative outputs rather than qualitative aspects of teaching effectiveness and student learning outcomes.	Current practice: At "Lucian Blaga" University of Sibiu, teaching and research staff are remunerated in accordance with Romanian legislation governing public institutions, and the university complies with the provisions of the Higher Education Law no. 199/2023 https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocument/271898 regarding the allocation of teaching hours. Teaching duties include scientific supervision of doctoral and postdoctoral students, and the workload incorporates a mandatory research component, with the number of research hours varying by academic rank. Internal guidelines stipulate that teaching staff must publish at least two scientific papers, with professors and associate professors required to publish at least one paper indexed in WoS or Scopus. Annual evaluation of teaching and research activity is conducted through the GRADIS https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/gradis/ tool, which includes 18 didactic indicators and 17 research indicators, and is linked to career progression, ensuring that advancement is aligned with publications and grants. Staff professional development is supported through lifelong learning programs, institutional development projects, and EU-funded initiatives, which provide access to modern teaching methodologies and innovative pedagogical approaches. Suggestions for improvement: The University should develop a structured internal procedure to encourage and support research in staff members' PhD fields and teaching areas. It should also integrate tutorial, supervision, and mentoring responsibilities for full and associate professors to guide younger teaching staff and early-career researchers. Finally, evaluation processes should be complemented with qualitative measures to better capture teaching innovation, effectiveness, and impact on student learning.

Status

34. Complains/ appeals

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
-/+ partially implemented	The ULBS has poor actions implemented so far in respect to complaints and appeals. These are usually received by an ad-hoc established committee, which gives different kinds of solutions or sanctions upon the examination of complaints, such as: sending written warning notice, career demotion with decreased salary for max 60 days, other shares of salary cut for a limited number of days or even the enforcement of termination of the employment contract.	Current practice: At the Lucian Blaga University of Sibiu, the Regulation of the University Ethics Commission is the document we refer to when it comes to solving complaints / appeals of researchers. (Link) https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/despre/organizare/structura/consilii-si-comisii/comisia-de-etica/ 1) Any person may report to the ULBS University Ethics Committee the commission of an act that may constitute a breach of university ethics and deontology. The complaint can be made in writing or online and must be registered at the school's registry. 2) All complaints received by the University Ethics Committee at the University level are registered, regardless of whether they are admissible or inadmissible. The registration number will be forwarded to the complainant at the contact address mentioned. (3) Anonymous complaints will not be taken into consideration, with the exceptions provided by law. (4) The identity of the complainant shall be kept confidential. (5) Failure to comply with the provisions on maintaining the confidentiality of the identity of the author of the complaint shall constitute a disciplinary offense. (6) Any referral received by the University Ethics Committee will be subject to an admissibility check, in accordance with the provisions of the Code of University Ethics and Deontology. In order to be admissible, complaints must cumulatively contain the following: a) the signature of the person making the complaint; b) identification data of the person lodging the complaint: name and surname of the natural person or name of the legal entity, its address and, where applicable, correspondence address, which may also be an e-mail address; c) a reasoned statement of the reasons for non-compliance with the rules of academic ethics and deontology, with concrete examples and an indication of the justifying considerations and sources of documentation. (7) If, following the regularization of the complaint, the petitioner does not cover the shortcomings indicated by the commission, it will be rejected as inadmissible by a reasoned decision, which will be communicated within 5 working days to the address indicated in the complaint. The person who has not lodged an admissible complaint shall have the right to resume the application in compliance with the provisions of paragraph. (5), within the time limit for decision (8) If the proceedings of the file show that there are reasonable suspicions that a criminal act has been committed, the committee shall notify the management of the institution as a matter of urgency and shall provide it with all the information it has in its possession in order to refer the matter to the judicial authorities (9) In order to analyze and solve the breaches of the rules of ethics and academic deontology, the ethics committees have the right to take the matter into their own hands. Internal regulation: ULBS Code of conduct https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/111220/2_Regulament%20de%20ordine%20interioara_Senat_dec2020.pdf describes the facts that represent misconduct within the frame of the ULBS organization in accordance with the National Labour Code (Law 53/2003 https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocumentAfis/41625) for all categories of employees, including researchers. National regulation: Government Decision 970/2023 https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocumentAfis/275396 approves the Methodology regarding the prevention and the fight against the harassment based on sex, as well as moral harassment at work. Suggestions for improvement: In the next years, ULBS will take steps into implementing its own Methodology to align with the newly adopted Government Decision 970/2023 https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocumentAfis/275396 which states that the implementation of this methodology, adapted to the specific situation of the employer/manager, with the mention that each employer can develop its own guide on preventing and combating harassment based on sex, as well as moral harassment at work, adapted to specific working conditions , in compliance with the terms and principles set out in the annex to the methodology. Other steps needed to be implemented: 1. Aligned with the Law 970/2003, ULBS will take effort to provide training to all employees, by organizing courses on the provisions of the methodology, on an annual basis and disseminate the methodology through all internal means of communication/informing employees. 2. An ombudsman-type) person to deal with complaints/ appeals of researchers would be an effective means of promoting a fair treatment Proposals: Action Plan, Action 12

Status**35. Participation in decision-making bodies**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	Limited representation of early-career researchers in decision-making bodies, which could affect their influence on research policies and institutional development.	Current Status: Partially implemented; participation exists but may not be inclusive, potentially marginalizing early-career researchers. ULBS likely has structures for researcher participation, such as faculty councils or research committees, given its governance framework. However, early-career researchers, such as PhD students and postdocs, may have limited representation in these bodies. According to the ULBS Charter https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/CARTA-ULBS_2015.pdf the teaching staff / researchers, the students and the administrative staff are represented and are participating in ULBS Senat, the decision making process of ULBS. Also the Higher Education Law 199 / 2023 https://edu.ro/sites/default/files/_fi%C8%99iere/Minister/2023/Legi_educatie_Romania_educata/legi_monitor/Legea_invatamantului_superior_nr_199.pdf is clearly describing the participation of the employees of the university in the decision making process. The Collective Labour Contract for ULBS https://www.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/documents/generale/CCM_ULBS_2022.pdf clearly states how the ULBS employees are being protected individually and collectively. Suggestions for Improvement: Ensure that researchers, especially early-career researchers, have opportunities to participate in decision-making processes that affect their work, such as reserving seats for PhD students and postdocs in governance bodies. Proposals: Action Plan Action 12

Training and Development**36. Relation with supervisors**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	Although open communication and regular supervision exist, there is no structured mentorship system to support continuous professional development. Guidance for new teaching staff is limited to initial integration, lacking ongoing, formalized support.	Current practice: Within ULBS there is an open relation between University/Faculty/Department management with their staff. The PhD students have an open and permanent relationship with their supervisors in the development of their thesis, research activity. PhD students are periodically reporting their research activity by following a specific procedure. All PhD student reporting must bear the approval of their supervisor. All PhD students are required to participate in specific courses (within the PhD School) like: Research methodology; Academic and research ethics etc. Young / new teaching assistants / teaching staff are closely supervised in their first academic year in order to ensure a proper integration within the ULBS academic environment Within the ULBS Carta https://senat.ulbsibiu.ro/wp-content/uploads/CARTA-ULBS_2015.pdf , the heads of departments have the role of supervising the activity of teaching staff /researchers that work within their departments. The heads of departments are having regular meetings with teaching staff /researchers to assess / discuss / improve the activity of their departments. All heads of academic structures of ULBS have mandatory office hours when they meet with the teaching / research staff that are part of their structure. Young / new teaching assistants / teaching staff are supported in the development of their annual reporting process of their research and didactic activity. Suggestions for Improvement: Establish a structured mentorship program or procedure where experienced faculty members systematically guide and support new or younger teaching and research staff throughout their early academic career, beyond the initial integration period. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 2

Status**37. Supervision and managerial duties**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	No formal support or training for supervisors to manage their workload, which could impact the quality of supervision and their own research productivity.	Current Status: Supervisors at ULBS are likely managing multiple responsibilities, including their own research, teaching, and administrative duties. However, there may be no formal support for workload management, potentially leading to overburdening. The strategic plan aims to increase doctoral supervisors, but supervision duties are not detailed. The ethics regulations focus on research ethics. Suggestions for Improvement: Provide training and support for supervisors to manage their time effectively, ensuring they can fulfill their supervisory roles without compromising their own research or other duties. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 14

38. Continuing Professional Development

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	Lack of Centralized Coordination: No unified platform integrates training across research centers, COCerc activities, and legal mandates, hindering accessibility. Limited Mandatory Engagement: Despite legal obligations, CPD remains voluntary for most staff beyond doctoral mandates, reducing consistent participation	Current practice ULBS complies with legal obligations under Title VI of the Labour Law (Law No. 53/2003, amended and republished on November 17, 2024), requiring an annual professional development plan and training for all staff, including teaching and research personnel, at least every two years, with paid or unpaid time off for development activities. This is supported by voluntary workshops, courses, and summer/winter schools offered through its 21 research centers, with mobility allowed during semesters if teaching duties are rescheduled to avoid impacting students. For doctoral students, Law No. 199/2023 on Higher Education mandates individualized CPD, targeting 20% for abroad training and ensuring support for conferences, workshops, and seminars related to their thesis, integrated into the Doctoral School's regulations. COCerc enhances CPD by hosting 6 debates, 6 science cafés, 5 exhibitions, 30 school visits, 10 lab events, career orientation for 500 students, and 5 advanced services for 125 PhD students, 30 postdocs, 150 young researchers, and 50 mature researchers (aiming for 90% positive evaluations), alongside capacity building and HRS4R certification. ULBS, is bound by legal obligations under Title VI of the Labour Law (Law No. 53/2003 https://www.mmuncii.ro/j33/images/Documente/MMJS/english/2018_LAW53-2003_Labour-Code.pdf , amended and republished on November 17, 2024, requiring an annual professional development plan and training for all staff, including teaching and research personnel, at least every two years. The law mandates paid or unpaid time off for professional development, with costs for formal training potentially covered by employees or the employer, as outlined in Government Ordinance No. 129/2000. These provisions apply to ULBS's 680+ staff. Additionally, ULBS facilitates research staff participation in workshops, courses, and summer/winter schools in Romania and abroad, allowing mobility during semesters with rescheduled teaching duties to avoid impacting students, supported by its 21 research centers. For doctoral students, Law No. 199/2023 on Higher Education https://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocument/271898 and national doctoral regulations mandate individualized professional development training, targeting 20% for abroad and ensuring support for conferences, workshops, and seminars related to their thesis, integrated into the Doctoral School's regulations. While no major implementation impediments are evident, potential resource or workload challenges may exist, and minor 2025 updates to these laws remain unverified. Suggestions for Improvement: • Develop an online portal on the ULBS website to consolidate CPD offerings, COCerc services, and legal training plans. • Implement Continuous Monitoring: Introduce regular feedback mechanisms to refine CPD, ensuring compliance with legal and institutional goals. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 3

Status**39. Access to research training and continuous development**

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	While various in-house and external training opportunities are available, access is not centralized, and information is often fragmented or self-sought. There is no unified platform or structured strategy to coordinate, promote, and track continuous research training and development.	Current practice: In the past years, training was made available in-house for both general academic skills (academic writing, information retrieval, reference management, research proposal writing) as well as specific research skills (certain methodologies, specific software). Information about available in-house training was provided via internal communication channels (e-mail). ULBS will continue to provide in-house training as part of the services developed in the CoCerc project. Information about external training is either identified by researchers or their own (professional associations) or comes from service providers to the ULBS (such as Enformation https://www.e-nformation.ro/ , a scientific resources provider). ULBS is able to assess the accessibility, take-up and effectiveness of in-house training. Thus, in 2020, 85 researchers benefited from in-house academic writing training, while 275 were trained in qualitative methodology, design thinking, case study research (FDI funded project, Education quality at the ULBS). In 2021, 60 ULBS researchers have benefited from academic writing training, 28 have received specific training on writing research applications, 55 were trained on using statistical analysis and bibliography management software, and 64 on information retrieval (FDI funded project, Knowhow transfer for academic excellence,). It must be noted that researchers were able to access more than one course/workshop/training per year. ULBS offers various research training opportunities through its 23 research centers https://cercetare.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/infrastructura-de-cercetare/centre-de-cercetare/lista-centre-de-cercetare/ , including workshops, conferences, and seminars. The ULBS D-School, the first University Center in Romania to teach and research design thinking, likely provides some training, but there is no centralized platform for research training. ULBS provides its researchers access to training for the development of their skills and competencies on a continuing basis. Suggestions for Improvement: Inclusion of an indicator of the participation of staff in research related trainings in the research-focused component of the GRADIS system (2025). Proposals: Action Plan, Action 9 Action Plan, Action 11

40. Supervision

Implementation	GAP / Implementation impediments	Initiatives undertaken/new proposals
+/- almost but not fully i...	No formal training for supervisors or mechanisms to evaluate supervisory quality, potentially affecting researcher satisfaction and outcomes	Current Status: Implemented; supervision is provided, but standardization and quality assurance may be lacking. Researchers, especially early-career researchers, should receive adequate supervision and mentoring to support their research and career development. ULBS has 105 doctoral supervisors guiding over 450 PhD students, indicating a strong supervisory framework. The Doctoral School https://doctorate.ulbsibiu.ro/ro/ likely defines roles and responsibilities, but the quality of supervision may vary across departments. Suggestions for Improvement: Implement regular training for supervisors and introduce annual surveys to evaluate mentor performance, ensuring high-quality guidance for researchers. Proposals: Action Plan, Action 14